

International Cybersecurity and Digital Forensics Academy

School of Governance, Risk and Compliance

Batch A2025

ICDFA Phase 1 Competency Examination (Draft Copy)

Paper	Component	Date	Time Window (WAT)	Mode	Duration	Key Notes
Paper 1	Objective (Knowledge & Principles)	Thursday, 20 Nov 2025	10:00 AM – 11:59 PM	Online CBT (LMS)	60 mins (auto timer)	Start anytime within the window. Submission closes automatically at 11:59 PM.
Paper 2	Practical (Hands-On Skills Test)	Friday, 21 Nov 2025	10:00 AM – 11:59 PM	Remote Lab/VM (Proctored)	90–120 mins (lab-timed)	Ensure stable internet and pre-tested VM access before launch.
Paper 3	Oral Defense (Professional Reasoning)	Sat 22 – Sun 23 Nov 2025	10:00 AM – 4:30 PM Daily	Zoom / Google Meet	15 mins per candidate	6 Panels total (A–F). 3 panels per day running concurrently.

Paper 3 Oral Defense Schedule

Day	Date	Panels	Slots per Panel	Total Capacity	Notes
Saturday	22 Nov 2025	Panel A, Panel B, Panel C	27 slots each (15 mins)	81 Candidates	Virtual sessions begin at 10:00 AM and close at 4:30 PM.
Sunday	23 Nov 2025	Panel D, Panel E, Panel F	~23 slots each (15 mins)	68 Candidates	Balance of candidates; same timing structure.

Rescheduling & Attendance Policy

- Candidates with **verified clashes (official duties, health issues)** may swap with another on the **same day** only.
- Requests must be sent **48 hours before the slot**, copying the **Panel Coordinator**.
- **Day changes are not permitted** except by express approval from the **Commandant**.

Trainee Access & Requirements

- **Paper 1 & 2 links** (LMS and Lab) will be shared **30 minutes** before the start window.
- **Oral Defense links** (unique per panel) will be shared **24 hours before the session**.
- **Screen policy:** Camera **ON**, mic **muted until called**.

Scoring & Conduct Framework

Paper	Assessment Focus	Scoring Methodology
Paper 1	Knowledge & principles	Automated objective scoring. Negative marking may apply for flagged guess patterns.
Paper 2	Technical execution & methodology	Evaluated based on accuracy, procedure, tool handling, data analysis, and incident response quality.
Paper 3	Reasoning & professional articulation	Evaluated based on clarity, decision reasoning, ethics, and risk awareness.
Integrity Clause	Academic honesty & discipline	Collusion or unauthorized help results in automatic disqualification .